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Dubai tops global travel time rankings

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai is redefining urban life. With cutting-edge metro lines, smart roads, and seamless public transport, the city now outpaces some of the world's busiest metropolises, turning daily commutes into a breeze.

Covering 10 kilometres in just 13.7 minutes on average, Dubai surpasses cities like Sydney, Berlin, and Milan, proving that strategic infrastructure is not just about roads and rails, but about reshaping the way a city lives, works, and grows, according to a new study shared by the Dubai Roads and Transport Authority (RTA).

Dubai's Travel Time Index (TTI) has improved from 1.28 in 2014 to 1.23 in 2024, reflecting a 4 per cent reduction in travel times over the past decade. The city's urban road network and smart traffic management have earned Dubai a top ranking in the TomTom Traffic Index 2024, outperforming major cities such as Sydney, Montreal, Berlin, Rome, and Milan in traffic flow efficiency.

Dubai's success also lies in cost-efficient infrastructure delivery. Constructing one kilometre of metro in Dubai costs 36 per cent less than London and 55 per cent less than Sydney, highlighting world-class project management and financial prudence.

UAE Cabinet approves largest budget of Dh92.4b for 2026

BALANCED REVENUE, EXPENDITURE AFFIRMS COMMITMENT TO DEVELOPMENT

DUBAI
BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE Cabinet, chaired by His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, approved the 2026 federal budget of Dh92.4 billion, during a meeting held yesterday at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi.

The budget, estimated at Dh92.4 billion in both revenues and expenditures, is the largest in the nation's history since the establishment of the Union. Shaikh Mohammad said the 2026 budget reaffirms the UAE's commitment to balanced development and strengthens the federal governance framework.

On his X account, Shaikh Mohammad wrote: "I chaired today's Cabinet meeting at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi, during which we approved the federal budget for 2026, with estimated revenues of Dh92.4 billion and balanced expenditures of the same amount."

Sustainable development

The Vice-President added: "The 2026 federal budget is the largest since the establishment of the Union – a budget that strengthens the federal system and reflects our continued commitment to balanced and sustainable development."

The Cabinet approved the creation of a programme to support and reinforce the Federal Financial Centre through



Dubai Media Office

■ Shaikh Mohammad chairs a Cabinet meeting at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi yesterday.

annual allocations from the federal budget, aimed at ensuring the long-term financial sustainability of federal institutions.

The Cabinet also reviewed the results of the UAE's 2024 National Agenda for Outward Foreign Direct Investment, which showed the country's cumulative foreign investment abroad reaching Dh1.05 trillion – a 9 per cent increase from the previous year. The UAE now ranks first in the Arab world and among the top 20 global economies in outward foreign direct investment.

Shaikh Mohammad said the figures reflect the strength and expanding global reach of the UAE's economy. "Our investments continue to grow, our trade is accelerating, and our economy is moving steadily forward," he emphasised.

103% rise in exports

During the meeting, the Cabinet also approved 35 international agreements and memoranda of understanding in the fields of economy and cooperation.

It further reviewed the progress of the UAE's export de-

velopment policy, which saw the country's exports rise from around Dh470 billion in 2019 to Dh950 billion in 2024 – a 103 per cent increase.

"Our budgets are balanced, our investments are growing, and our nation continues to advance in prosperity and stability under the leadership of my brother, His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan," Shaikh Mohammad added. "Together, we continue to move from one peak to another, ensuring a dignified life for our people and all who call the UAE home."

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TELL ME WHY

In this episode, produced in association with Femfresh, Dr Fadia Alkhalil dispels myths about feminine intimate hygiene



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UAE Lottery's Dh100 million jackpot winner's name revealed

Lucky Indian's video and details released nine days after win

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The suspense is finally over. The UAE Lottery yesterday officially revealed the full identity of the Dh100 million jackpot winner, the biggest prize in the nation's lottery history.

After over a week of speculation surrounding the name "Anilkumar" B," the man behind the masked moniker has been revealed in an official statement released by the lottery operator.

Anilkumar Bolla, a 29-year-old Indian expat and long-time Abu Dhabi resident, struck gold in The UAE Lottery's 23rd Lucky Day Draw #251018 held on Saturday, October 18, becoming an instant multimillionaire and



forever signing his name in The UAE Lottery's record books, the lottery operator announced. The UAE Lottery also released a photo and a video of the winner for the first time.

At the time of the draw, Anilkumar was at home relaxing when he received the life-changing call from The UAE Lottery. He first shared the exciting news with a colleague before calling his brother back home in India. Recounting the event, he said: "When I received a call from The UAE Lottery, I thought it was surreal. I kept asking them to repeat the message. It took time to sink in, and even today, I still can't believe my new reality."

He added: "This sum will change my life forever. I plan to buy a supercar first and treat myself to a month-long stay at a 7-star hotel."

SPORT

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